

English Learning App (ELA) Questionnaire

Dear student,

We are conducting this study to learn more about the experience of international students at Foothill and De Anza Colleges when learning English as a second language.

You will be asked a series of questions about your current English skills, your experience using apps, and what features you would like to see in mobile apps. No personally identifiable information will be collected, so your responses will remain anonymous. This means no one will be able to identify you when the results are recorded and reported. Your participation will enhance our ability to develop the most effective app and should take about 10-15 minutes.

This study presents no physical risks or harm beyond those involved in daily, normal computer use. There are not any psychological risks or harm beyond those involved in daily, normal life. Some instructors may provide their students with a small amount of extra credit as incentive to fill out the questionnaire. The extra credit will be minimal such that it will not significantly impact a student's grade. If you are receiving extra credit from your instructor, please take a screenshot of the last survey page to provide evidence for completing the survey. Other than the possibility of an extra credit, we do not and cannot guarantee or promise that you will receive any benefits from this study.

Your participation in this study is totally voluntary and you may withdraw at any time without negative consequences. If you wish to withdraw at any time during the study, simply close the survey window.

If you have any questions, concerns, or complaints about the way this study is being conducted or about your rights as a participant, please contact Devi Amarsaikhan at deviamar622@gmail.com or Dr. Eta Lin at lineta@foothill.edu.

If you agree to participate, you may continue with this online questionnaire. By filling out the questionnaire, you are giving your consent to participate. If you do not want to participate, you may exit the survey now by closing this tab. Have a wonderful rest of your day.

Please note the following two requirements:

1. Student is over the age of 18
2. Student is learning English as a second language and or taking ESL classes

Questions

1. Please confirm you are over the age of 18 by typing "YES".

If yes, the survey will continue to the next section. If not, the survey will not proceed.

English Skills and Goals

1. What is your first/native language? (text box; open ended question)
 - a. Spanish
 - b. Vietnamese
 - c. Arabic
 - d. Punjabi
 - e. Korean
 - f. Burmese
 - g. Mandarin / Cantonese / other Chinese dialect
 - h. Filipino / Tagalog / other Filipino dialect
 - i. Iranian / Persian / Farci dialect
 - j. Hindi / other Indic dialect
 - k. Other (Please specify)
2. What are some differences between your first language and English? (multiple choice question; check all that apply)
 - a. Has gendered nouns

- b. Does not have alphabet
 - c. Different articles (a, an, the)
 - d. Different parts of speech (noun, conjunction, etc.)
 - e. Different personal pronouns (I, he, she, they, etc.)
 - f. Different verb tenses (past perfect, present continuous, etc.)
 - g. Different phonemes (sounds that make up words like the 'f' sound)
 - h. Different sentence structure (order of subject, verb, object in sentence)
 - i. Different number markers (more or less than just "singular" or "plural" in English)
 - j. Does not change word order when asking questions ("You are..." vs "Are you ...?")
 - k. Other (please specify)
3. What (if any) cultural shocks have you experienced? (multiple choice question; check all that apply)
- a. Direct communication style
 - b. Expectation to maintain eye contact
 - c. Expectation to have and share opinions
 - d. Expectation to participate in class and ask questions
 - e. Extensive knowledge about politics and current events
 - f. Informal communication (calling superiors by first name)
 - g. None
 - h. Other (please specify)
4. How many years have you been learning English? (text box; open-ended question)

5. What are the most confusing aspects of English for you? (multiple choice; check all that apply)

- a. Spelling
- b. Vocabulary
- c. Punctuation
- d. Pronunciation
- e. Slang (Lit, chill, etc.)
- f. Idioms (like "break a leg")
- g. Lack of historical context
- h. Exceptions to grammar rules
- i. Grammar (rules on how to use words to communicate)
- j. Cultural differences (expected to have and share opinion)
- k. Pop-culture references (i.e. tv shows, movies, celebrities, music)
- l. Homophones (same pronunciation, different spelling like to/too/two)
- m. Homonyms (same spelling, different meaning like kind: "caring" or "a type of")
- n. Other (please specify)

6. What is your goal for learning English? (multiple choice)

- a. Job
- b. School
- c. Travel
- d. Communicate better with friends and family
- e. Other

7. Briefly (in 1 sentence or 2) describe what success in English means for you (being able to communicate with friends and family, understand the news, etc.). (text box; open ended question)

	Strongly agree	Somewhat agree	Do not agree or disagree	Somewhat disagree	Strongly disagree
I feel comfortable speaking with my teacher in English					
I feel comfortable speaking with friends in English					
I feel comfortable communicating in English for everyday tasks (e.g., shopping, asking for directions)					
I feel comfortable using English when engaging in social media or online forums.					
I can watch English movies or TV shows without subtitles.					
I feel comfortable using slang in conversation in English					
I can understand articles in English.					
I feel comfortable working on assignments (i.e. essays) in English					
I feel comfortable giving presentations in English.					
I feel comfortable writing formal emails or reports in English.					
I can easily understand spoken					

English in fast-paced conversations. (i.e. news coverage)					
I can understand English speakers with various accents.					
I can understand common idiomatic expressions (e.g., cost an arm and a leg).					
I can understand the questions and phrases in this survey.					
I am usually able to express myself clearly in English					
I find it challenging to remember the right word to say in English					
I find it challenging to construct grammatically correct sentences in English.					
I find it challenging to pronounce certain English words.					
I often need to pause and think when responding to questions in English.					
I feel like my accent makes it hard to communicate with others.					

Rating App Features

Which of the following app features will help you reach your English learning goals?

	Very helpful	Somewhat helpful	Neither helpful nor unhelpful	Somewhat unhelpful	Very unhelpful
Daily/Weekly study reminders					

Study streaks					
Point awards for practicing					
Predefined lists of new vocabulary to study					
Ability to create your own flashcards					
Ability to translate text to your native language					
Feature to practice speaking by mimicking dialogue					
Feature to interact directly with other users through chat or phone calls					
Games to match words to their definitions to practice vocabulary					
Tests and quizzes for vocabulary/grammar/reading comprehension					
Ability to keep track of mistakes so you can review them					
Provides instant feedback					
App is ad free					
App is free					
App does not use wifi					
App does not lag/crash					
App does not store your data					
App stores some data but anonymously					

Are there specific features you wish existed in language learning apps but haven't found yet?
(text box; open-ended question)

App Usage

1. Which of the following devices do you have access to and use often?
 - a. Iphone
 - b. Samsung (Android)
 - c. Pixel (Google)
 - d. Desktop
 - e. Laptop
 - f. Tablet
 - g. Other (Please specify)
2. Do you use language learning apps? (Multiple choice. Will go to appropriate section based on user answer)
 - a. Yes
 - b. No

Experience with Language Learning Apps (Optional)

3. What language learning apps do you use? (Not necessarily for English) (text box to list apps)
4. If more than one, which app do you use the most frequently? Focus on this app when answering the following questions. (short answer)
5. What do you like about this app?
 - a. Easy to use

- b. Nice visual format
 - c. Fun learning activities
 - d. Doesn't need wifi connection
 - e. Effective in language learning
 - f. Other (Please specify)
6. What skills does the app address? (multiple choice)
- a. Vocabulary
 - b. Grammar
 - c. Writing
 - d. Speaking
 - e. Reading comprehension
 - f. Listening comprehension
 - g. Other
7. What skills do you practice on the app? (multiple choice)
- a. Vocabulary
 - b. Grammar
 - c. Writing
 - d. Speaking
 - e. Reading comprehension
 - f. Listening comprehension
 - g. Other
8. What frustrations have you experienced with language learning apps?
- a. Not clear

- b. Hard to navigate
- c. Takes too long to load
- d. Needs wifi connection
- e. App takes too much space on phone
- f. Other (Please specify)

Experience with Language Learning Apps (Optional)

9. If you do not currently use an app, did you try using apps in the past? (Yes or no)
10. If you answered yes, why did you stop? (text box)
- a. Hard to use
 - b. Not effective
 - c. Too many ads
 - d. Too expensive
 - e. Crashed frequently
 - f. Boring, repetitive activities
 - g. Other (Please specify)
11. If you answered no, why did you choose not to use language learning apps? (text box; open-ended question)
- a. Did not know about language learning apps
 - b. Did not feel comfortable using an app or mobile devices
 - c. Heard language learning apps were not effective or boring
 - d. Other (Please specify)

Debriefing script

Thank you so much for taking the time to complete this survey. The purpose was to determine common challenges associated with learning English and develop an app to address them.

If you are taking this survey for extra credit, please take a screenshot of this last page with the survey title and send it to your instructor.

Your information will be kept anonymous and confidential. If you have any questions or concerns about our survey, please contact Devi Amarsaikhan at deviamar622@gmail.com and Dr. Eta Lin at lineta@fhda.edu.